SESSION 04 / PRINTABLE GUIDE

Fabric Notebook survival guide

Session 04 | Keep beside the notebook
Use only your assigned training workspace/Lakehouse. Confirm prerequisites before class.

Before Run all

Check **language, default Lakehouse, inputs, write targets, and approval flags**. Read Markdown instructions first. Starters intentionally stop at unfinished practice cells; the main lab also stops at its write-approval gate. Saving code does not persist data, and visible old output is not proof of a current successful run.

Where am I reading or writing?

Reference	Meaning
`Files/session_04/scenario/...`	Relative Spark path in the attached default Lakehouse
Path copied from Lakehouse UI	Explicit resource address; verify item/cloud and the copied path type
ADLS endpoint + container/prefix	External source used by the prepared ingestion pipeline
`s04_lab_device_silver`	Spark table in the current Lakehouse/catalog context
`gold.s04_lab_device_daily`	Warehouse table for Warehouse SQL, not an automatically shared Spark table
Laptop Downloads folder	Not directly readable by the hosted notebook

Use the prepared folder and actual tenant path; do not guess endpoints or collect files from a different Lakehouse to make a cell green.

If it stops, classify before changing anything

Symptom	First check
`NotImplementedError` / labeled safety stop	Complete the task or obtain write approval; not a service outage
`NameError`	Defining/import cells and execution order; if `spark` is missing, check PySpark/session

Symptom	First check
Syntax/indentation error	Code cell language, spelling, brackets, and indentation
Column cannot be resolved	`printSchema()` and the DataFrame being queried
File/table not found	Default Lakehouse, path/name/case, prepared source, and current catalog/schema
Access denied	Which resource and execution identity? Ask the owner; do not weaken controls
Package/module missing	Approved runtime/environment; do not install random fixes during delivery
Cell pending/slow	Session startup versus an active job; inspect progress before retrying

Record the useful error, failing cell, input/target, and run reference. Never include tokens/keys in screenshots. Opening a notebook does not grant Lakehouse, ADLS connection/source, or Warehouse permissions.

Everyday habits

Use completion and `help(F.trim)` instead of memorizing APIs. Add Markdown describing the question, source scope, grain, and expected result. Prefer built-in Spark expressions; a Spark Column is not a Python scalar. Profile full batches, label samples, and aggregate/bound data before collecting to pandas or the driver.

Before declaring success

Verify counts, rejection reasons, grain, and actual persisted output. Spark exports can be folders of part files; a Delta table has data files and a transaction log. Do not manually edit underlying table files. `append` can duplicate reruns; `overwrite` replaces a target; warm-up uses `errorifexists` and needs a new approved target for a second creation. Restart clears variables/temp views, not persisted tables. Notebook success is not proof of Warehouse copy, Gold publication, or model freshness. End your own session according to customer guidance.

Practice: Notebook 101 -> main lab -> independent challenge.

Source: notebook_survival_guide.md. Companion-material links open the repository originals.